



PRESENTER SCRIPT · 90 MINUTES

INTRO TO SYNTHESIS

One beat per slide, with a running clock. Every beat has four lines: SAY / SHOW / THEY DO / IF RUNNING LATE. 21 September 2026 · Club Control, Bucharest · Sinteaur × Zeedo · powered by Sequential.

BEFORE DOORS

- All synths powered on, **main** at 12 o'clock, sound in both headphones at every station, Basic Program loaded on all of them (hold **transpose down** + **program**).
- On the loaner units: keybed firmware (keymech OS $\geq$ 1.0.0.2 — older versions send maximum aftertouch on the bottom octave); Global: Aftertouch = Poly, Clock Mode = Out or Off (on In the arp waits for external clock), Velocity Curve = Medium; run "Tune Voices" after 15 minutes of warm-up.
- Presenter's synth → PA (main out, mono 1/4"), microphone tested from the back of the room; 16:9 screen, the RO deck open on the title slide, clicker; overhead camera framed on the panel (if available).
- On your own synth: the "wow" preset for 00:03 and "Glass Echo" (F1 17) for 06:05, both tested; the AT → LFO amount test done at home (its result decides the wording in 07:04).
- student handbooks (EN + RO) by the exit, not on the tables; water; photo/video.
- Presets to audition beforehand, for the DEMOs (names from the F1 list; check the sound yourself): 05 Syncing Pressure, 07 Mod My Arp, 17 Glass Echo, 18 Uptight Bass, 25 Dynamik Pad, 30 Unisyncerizer, 46 Acids Pro, 77 Poseidon PWM, 93 Hard Sync, 112 Aggro Feedback, 118 Bottle Service.

PLAN B

- **No projector:** teach from the panel and from the student handbook (its pages follow the slide order); overhead camera on a TV, if one exists.
- **No PA:** participants put their headphones down and you play your synth through an amp or a local speaker; demos get cut to half length.
- **A synth freezes or sounds wrong:** reset to Basic Program (hold **transpose down** + **program**); if it persists, check **main**, the mixer (at least one source up), **cutoff**, the amounts at 12 o'clock, **key track**; last resort: swap that station with yours.
- **If you fall more than 5 minutes behind,** cut in this order: 08:04 Note & Mod Seq → the long demo in 05 → 06:04 Chord memory → the 03:04 demo (kick) → the 07:05 demo → exercises shortened to 90 s, no swap.

0:00–0:05

00 · WELCOME & SETUP

00:01 TITLE · 00:02 TODAY · 00:03 DEMO · 00:04 FIRST CONTACT — detailed below.

0:00–0:05

MODULE 00 · WELCOME & SETUP

0:00–0:01

00:01 TITLE

SAY: “Welcome. I’m Iulian, from Sintezaur. Over the next ninety minutes you’ll come to understand every stage a sound passes through inside a subtractive synthesizer — and you’ll hear it, not from me, but from under your own fingers, on the instrument in front of you: the Sequential Fourm. Thank you to Zeedo, who made this possible, and to Sequential, who lent us the instruments. The map behind me is the whole course: eight stops, in the order the signal travels.”

SHOW: the title slide with the map. Headphones down.

THEY DO: —

IF RUNNING LATE: never cut.

0:01–0:03 00-02 TODAY

SAY: “Three things before we start. One: you’re two to a synth. One person drives, the other reads the steps and listens; swap at every exercise, so the panel passes through both pairs of hands. Two: headphones — on when you play, one ear free when I’m talking; MAIN volume at twelve o’clock, and we leave it there. Three: if you get lost, you have a home button: hold TRANSPOSE DOWN and press PROGRAM. That loads Basic Program — a plain saw with the filter open. That’s where we start from every time. Don’t press PROGRAM otherwise, or you’ll lose the sound you just built. And: there are no wrong sounds today. Explore first, then we talk.”

SHOW: the TODAY slide. Camera on your synth when you show TRANSPOSE DOWN + PROGRAM.

THEY DO: —

IF RUNNING LATE: never cut.

0:03–0:04 00-03 DEMO THE DISTANCE

SAY: “This is a factory sound.” (play the spectacular preset for 20 seconds) “And this is point zero.” (Basic Program, a few notes) “By the end we’ll have built the distance between these two — and you’ll know what every knob does along the way.”

SHOW: PA; headphones down; camera on your hands.

THEY DO: —

IF RUNNING LATE: shorten the demo to 10 s.

0:04–0:05 00-04 FIRST CONTACT

SAY: “Headphones on. Play a few notes on whatever is loaded right now. Then do the reset: hold TRANSPOSE DOWN, press PROGRAM. Play again: this plain saw is where every sound today starts from. Swap and repeat.”

SHOW: the TODAY slide stays up.

THEY DO: (A) plays a few notes → hold **transpose down** + press **program** → plays again. (B) the same. You walk the tables and check everyone is on Basic Program.

IF RUNNING LATE: this is the minute you never cut — one person who can’t reset costs you more later.

0:05–0:12 MODULE 01·SIGNAL FLOW

0:05–0:06 01-01 COVER

SAY: “The whole course rests on a single idea: sound follows a path. Learn the path once and no synthesizer will ever look complicated again, no matter how many knobs it has.”

SHOW: cover 01. Headphones down.

IF RUNNING LATE: never cut.

0:06–0:07 01-02 WHAT'S IN A SOUND

SAY: “What’s inside a sound? A note isn’t a single frequency: it’s one base frequency, the fundamental, plus a tower of quieter tones stacked above it — the harmonics. Their blend is what we hear as timbre. A saw has all of them, a square only the odd ones, a triangle almost none — that’s why one is bright, one hollow, one soft. Subtractive synthesis starts from a rich wave and takes away. Think of a sculptor: the raw block is the wave, the chisel is the filter, and the shape over time comes

from the envelopes.” **DEMO (20 s):** a lone saw — “a boring buzz, like the cheapest transistor organ” — then the same saw with the filter half closed and a slow attack: “the same block, sculpted.”

SHOW: the What's in a sound slide; PA; headphones down.

IF RUNNING LATE: cut the demo, keep the sculptor line.

0:07-0:08 01-03 THE VOICE PATH

SAY: “Left to right: the oscillators make the raw tone, the mixer balances four sources, the filter sculpts the brightness, the amplifier shapes the volume, the speaker gets the result. The dotted line: the Fourm can feed its own signal back into the mixer — feedback; we'll use it in module 6.”

SHOW: the Voice path slide.

IF RUNNING LATE: never cut.

0:08-0:09 01-04 WHERE ON FOURM

SAY: “Here's the best part: the panel is laid out in the same order as the path. Look at your synth and put a finger on it: oscillators, mixer, filter, envelopes, main. The sections on the left — modulation, aftertouch — and the ones along the bottom — unison, glide, LFO, clock, arpeggiator — we'll take one by one, in the modules ahead.”

SHOW: the Where on Fourm slide; camera on your panel, hand on each section as you name it.

IF RUNNING LATE: never cut.

0:09-0:10 01-05 THE MIXER

SAY: “Four sources: Osc A, Osc B, noise, feedback. The golden rule of troubleshooting, which I'll repeat all evening: if you hear nothing, check the mixer first, then the cutoff, then any amount knob left at twelve o'clock.” **DEMO** bring up Osc A alone, add B, then a hiss of noise on top.

SHOW: the Mixer slide; PA.

IF RUNNING LATE: cut the demo.

0:10-0:12 01-06 TRY IT

SAY: “Headphones on. From Basic Program: hold a note and take OSC A in the mixer down to zero. Silence — no source, no sound. Bring it back. Press SAW on Oscillator B and raise OSC B: two oscillators, one note, already fatter. Swap: your partner does the same, and at the end, trace the path across the panel with a finger.”

SHOW: the Mixer slide stays up.

THEY DO: (A) **osc a** to zero → silence → back up; Osc B **saw** on; **osc b** up. (B) repeats; both trace the path with a finger. You walk the tables.

IF RUNNING LATE: 1 minute instead of 2, no swap.

0:12 01-07 KEY TERMS

SAY: “The terms: VCO, mixer, VCF, VCA, feedback, harmonics. They come back in every module; stop me now if any of them is unclear.” A real three-second pause.

SHOW: Key Terms.

IF RUNNING LATE: 15 seconds.

0:12-0:23 MODULE 02 · OSCILLATORS

0:12-0:13 02-01 COVER

SAY: “First stop: the place where sound is born. Everything further down the path only removes or reshapes what the oscillators give us. That's why the waveshapes matter so much.”

SHOW: cover 02. Headphones down.

0:13-0:15 02-02 THE WAVESHAPES

SAY: “Three shapes, three personalities. Saw: all the harmonics, the bright workhorse — brass, strings. Triangle: soft, almost pure — the sub layer. Pulse: hollow like a clarinet when it's square, thin and nasal as it narrows — with a secret parameter we'll open up in a moment.” **DEMO** same note, slowly switch through the three shapes. Then the game (30 s): “Which shape is this?” — play saw / pulse / tri at random, the room shouts. “Learn to recognize them and you'll hear them in every track from now on.”

SHOW: the Waveshapes slide; PA; headphones down.

IF RUNNING LATE: the game at 15 s.

0:15-0:16 02-03 OCTAVES & TUNING

SAY: “The registers: five octave positions, from minus two to plus two, on each oscillator; A and B an octave apart means instant size. FREQUENCY is the fine tuning, up to seven semitones. And here's the first secret of ‘fatness’: detune B slightly against A and the two waves start beating against each other — the sound breathes. Too far, and you hear two notes.”

DEMO B's **frequency** from center slowly to the left: slow beats → chorus → two notes → back.

SHOW: the Octaves & tuning slide; camera on the octave encoder and on **frequency**.

IF RUNNING LATE: never cut (it's the key of the module).

0:16-0:17 02-04 PULSE WIDTH & PWM

SAY: “The pulse's secret: its width. On the Fourm there's no knob — hold PULSE and turn SELECT. Zero is the square; toward the edge it thins out, like through a straw, until it disappears. Hand its width to the LFO and the tone won't sit still: a single oscillator that sounds like a chorus. That's PWM, and we'll do it in module 5.” **DEMO** sweep the PW by hand.

SHOW: the PW & PWM slide; camera on **pulse|pw + select**.

IF RUNNING LATE: 20 s, no demo.

0:17-0:18 02-05 THE SUB TRICK

SAY: “The ten-second trick: Osc B on triangle, one octave below A. The nearly pure wave slides underneath the tone and adds nothing but weight — no clutter.” **DEMO** A alone, add the sub, take it out — “the room has to feel the hole.”

SHOW: the Sub trick slide; PA.

0:18-0:19 02-06 NOISE

SAY: “Noise: every frequency at once, no pitch — the raw material of drums. Three colors: white is full, pink is warm, violet leans into the highs. Press NOISE, hold and turn SELECT for the level. A little sharpens the attack; a lot becomes percussion.”

DEMO (20 s): noise alone with a short envelope = hi-hat.

SHOW: the Noise slide; PA.

IF RUNNING LATE: no demo.

0:19-0:22 02-07 TRY IT

SAY: “Headphones on, from Basic Program. Osc A: press PULSE, so both saw and pulse are lit. Hold PULSE and turn SELECT toward the edge, then back. Osc B: press TRI, octave to minus one, raise OSC B in the mixer — put the sub in, take it out, feel the weight. Nudge B's FREQUENCY a little off center and listen to the beats; too far and it splits into two notes — bring it back. Press NOISE, hold and turn SELECT to about thirty: just a bit of air. Swap halfway.”

SHOW: the Noise or Sub trick slide; you walk the tables.

THEY DO: (A) Osc A: **pulse** on (saw + pulse) → hold **pulse|pw + select** toward the edge and back → Osc B: **tri** on, octave -1, **osc b** up → B's **frequency** slightly off-centre → back. (B) **noise** on → hold **noise + select** ~30 → plays; then repeats A's steps. The result stays on the synth: it's the raw material for the bass in module 4.

IF RUNNING LATE: 2 minutes: sub + noise, no PW.

0:22-0:23 02-08 KEY TERMS

SAY: “Recap: waveshape, harmonics, pulse width and PWM, sub, noise, the LO modes — for the curious, they’re in the student handbook. Question for the room: who has heard PWM in a track without knowing its name? Everyone, starting today.”

SHOW: Key Terms.

0:23–0:33

MODULE 03 · FILTER

0:23–0:24

03·01 COVER

SAY: “The oscillators gave us the block of harmonics. The filter is the chisel. It’s the most important knob on any synthesizer, and the one you’ll touch the most tonight.”

SHOW: cover 03. Headphones down.

0:24–0:26

03·02 LOW-PASS

SAY: “Low-pass means exactly what it says: what sits below a certain frequency passes, what sits above fades away. That frequency is the cutoff. Close it — darker; open it — brighter. It’s like a trumpet player’s hand over the bell: cover it and the sound turns softer, rounder, more muffled. Fully closed, nothing gets through — that’s why ‘I can’t hear anything’ almost always starts at the cutoff.” **DEMO** held chord, cutoff from open to closed and back, slowly.

SHOW: the Low-pass slide; PA; headphones down; camera on **cutoff**.

IF RUNNING LATE: never cut.

0:26–0:28

03·03 RESONANCE

SAY: “Resonance is an accent right at the cutoff. Picture a string stretched in front of a speaker: it only vibrates on its own when you hear its note — that’s resonance. A little gives focus and a vowel-like character when you move the cutoff: eee-yah-ooo-uuu” (sing the sweep with the room) “A lot makes the filter whistle alongside the note. At maximum, the filter feeds itself and produces a clean sine with no oscillator at all — like a microphone too close to a speaker. A fifth sound source.”

DEMO 1: sweep with resonance at three quarters. **DEMO 2 (30 s), “the filter becomes an oscillator”:** oscillators at zero in the mixer, resonance max, key track full → play a melody on the filter’s sine. Warning: “it comes in sudden and loud — bring the volume down a touch first.”

SHOW: the Resonance slide; PA; camera on **resonance**.

IF RUNNING LATE: DEMO 2 at 15 s.

0:28–0:29

03·04 KEY TRACK & ENV AMOUNT

SAY: “Two small things with a big effect. Key track: the cutoff follows the keyboard — higher notes get a more open filter, the way acoustic instruments behave; without it, the top notes vanish behind the filter. Hold KEY TRACK and choose with SELECT: quarter, half, full. With full tracking, the self-playing filter plays a tuned scale. And ENV AMT: how much the filter envelope moves the cutoff over the life of the note — plus or minus, with zero at twelve o’clock. That’s the story of the next module.” **Optional DEMO (20 s), “a kick from nothing”:** same as before + filter env with a short decay → a kick drum out of the filter.

SHOW: the Key track & env amount slide; camera on **key track** and **env amt**.

IF RUNNING LATE: a single sentence, no demo.

0:29–0:32

03·05 TRY IT

SAY: “Headphones on. Hold a chord. Cutoff slowly down until it’s dark, then back. Resonance to three o’clock and one more sweep: the whistle rides the sweep. Now, careful: bring MAIN down a little, resonance to maximum, close the cutoff a bit and play single notes — the filter sings on its own. Hold KEY TRACK, turn SELECT to Full and hear the top notes light up. To finish: resonance back to nine o’clock, cutoff to twelve — we keep this for the next module. Swap in the middle.”

SHOW: the Resonance slide stays up; you walk the tables.

THEY DO: (A) **cutoff** down → up; **resonance** at 3 o'clock, sweep. Swap. (B) **main** slightly down → **resonance** max → **cutoff** a bit closed → single notes; hold **key track** + **select** → Full; then **resonance** to 9 o'clock, **cutoff** to 12 o'clock.

IF RUNNING LATE: 2 minutes, no key track.

0:32–0:33 03-06 KEY TERMS

SAY: “Cutoff, resonance, self-oscillation, key track, env amount. Five words you'll use on every synth in the world. And a line worth remembering: run a Moog oscillator through a Korg filter and it sounds like a Korg — the filter carries the identity.”

SHOW: Key Terms.

0:33–0:44 MODULE 04 · ENVELOPES

0:33–0:34 04-01 COVER

SAY: “An oscillator through a filter is still a beep: it starts when you press, stops when you let go, and nothing happens in between. Real instruments have a shape in time. An organ starts and stops instantly. A plucked string starts loud and dies away. A bow swells into the note. The envelope is that shape, drawn with four knobs and replayed on every key.”

SHOW: cover 04. Headphones down.

0:34–0:36 04-02 ADSR

SAY: “Imagine turning a stereo's volume knob over the course of a single note: from zero to ten, then down to five, hold it there, and at the end back to zero. That drawing is the envelope. Attack: how long the climb from silence to the peak takes. Decay: how long the fall from the peak to the sustain level takes. Sustain: a level, not a time — where the sound sits while you hold the key. Release: how long the fade takes after you lift your finger. The brain recognizes an instrument from the first milliseconds: the attack matters most.” **DEMO** the same note with zero attack, then a long attack; then short vs long release.

SHOW: the ADSR slide; PA; camera on AMP ENVELOPE's four knobs.

IF RUNNING LATE: never cut.

0:36–0:37 04-03 TWO ENVELOPES ON FOURM

SAY: “The Fourm has two. The amp envelope drives the amplifier: the note's volume contour. The filter envelope drives the cutoff, by however much ENV AMT in the filter section allows: the brightness contour. Same shape, two jobs: how loud, how bright. Watch out for ENV AMT: it's bipolar, zero at twelve o'clock, plus to the right, minus to the left. Left at twelve, the filter envelope does nothing — the classic trap.” **DEMO “the pluck knob” (30 s):** saw, cutoff at half, env amt at three o'clock, filter decay from long to short — “the shorter the decay, the harder the sound plucks.”

SHOW: the Two envelopes slide; PA; camera on **env amt** and FILTER ENVELOPE **decay**.

IF RUNNING LATE: demo at 15 s.

0:37–0:38 04-04 BASS vs PAD

SAY: “The same oscillators, two instruments. Bass: instant attack, short decay, low sustain, short release — a pluck that bites. Pad: slow attack, no decay, sustain at maximum, long release — a sound that blooms. And three kitchen rules: with sustain at maximum, the decay has nowhere left to fall and does nothing; with sustain at zero, the note dies while you hold it — that's the pluck; a filter envelope slower than the amp envelope gives you the pad that opens up — the other way around you hear nothing, because the amplifier closes first.”

SHOW: the Bass vs Pad slide.

IF RUNNING LATE: never cut.

0:38–0:43 04-05 TRY IT

SAY: “Headphones on. Partner A builds the bass, B builds the pad, then show each other. Bass, from the module 2 sound: amp envelope — attack zero, decay ten o'clock, sustain eight o'clock, release eight o'clock. Filter envelope — attack zero,

decay ten o'clock, sustain minimum, release eight o'clock. In the filter: ENV AMT to three o'clock — from twelve toward the right! — and cutoff at nine o'clock. Short notes, low. Then shorten the filter decay: more pluck. Pad, partner B: amp envelope — attack twelve o'clock, decay zero, sustain maximum, release two o'clock. Cutoff at twelve o'clock, ENV AMT at ten o'clock. Osc B on saw, octave zero, FREQUENCY nudged a little. Hold a chord and let it bloom. The positions are starting points, not rules — listen."

SHOW: the Bass vs Pad slide stays up; you walk the tables, one ear on every station.

THEY DO: (A) BASS: AMP ENV **attack** 0 · **decay** 10 o'clock · **sustain** 8 o'clock · **release** 8 o'clock; FILTER ENV **attack** 0 · **decay** 10 o'clock · **sustain** min · **release** 8 o'clock; FILTER **env amt** 3 o'clock · **cutoff** 9 o'clock; short notes; then FILTER ENV **decay** shorter. Swap. (B) PAD: AMP ENV **attack** 12 o'clock · **decay** 0 · **sustain** max · **release** 2 o'clock; FILTER **cutoff** 12 o'clock · **env amt** 10 o'clock; OSC B **saw** on, octave 0, **frequency** slightly off-centre; hold a chord. Note the positions you liked in the student handbook, page 04.

IF RUNNING LATE: just the bass recipe, 3 minutes; the pad stays in the student handbook.

0:43–0:44

04.06 KEY TERMS

SAY: "Attack, decay, sustain, release, env amount, velocity. The envelope is what makes a synth sound like an instrument instead of a signal. And the beautiful part: four knobs describe almost every instrument on Earth."

SHOW: Key Terms.

0:44–0:53

MODULE 05 · LFO & MODULATION

0:44–0:45

05.01 COVER

SAY: "Envelopes give the note its shape; modulation keeps it alive. A sound that stands still sounds like a signal — every sound in nature moves. Modulation is the verb of synthesis: something moves something else."

SHOW: cover 05. Headphones down.

0:45–0:47

05.02 THE LFO

SAY: "LFO: low frequency oscillator. An oscillator too slow to hear as a note — you hear what it moves. Sent to pitch: vibrato, the violinist rocking a finger on the string. Sent to cutoff: wah. Sent to the amplifier: tremolo — the volume rocked twice a second. The FREQUENCY knob is the speed, SYNC ties it to the tempo, and the shapes can be combined: triangle for smooth vibrato, square for trills, sample and hold for random, stepped motion. Musical vibrato is small and about six or seven times a second; speed it up and it's not vibrato anymore, it's a growl." **DEMO (45 s):** one LFO → cutoff, FREQUENCY from very slow (ambient sweep) to 1–2 Hz (wah) to 15 Hz (growl); then the same LFO → pitch (vibrato) → amp (tremolo).

SHOW: The LFO slide; PA; camera on the LFO section.

IF RUNNING LATE: demo cutoff only, 20 s.

0:47–0:49

05.03 THE MODULATION SECTION

SAY: "Look at the left side of the panel. Three sources: filter env, osc B, and the LFO, each with a ROUTE button and an amount knob. Eight destinations on the right: freq A, freq B, PW A, PW B, cutoff, amp, LFO freq, LFO amount. Press ROUTE once — red LED, the direct bus: the modulation is always on. Press it twice — blue, the wheel bus: the modulation only appears as you raise the mod wheel. The wheel becomes the modulation's volume — without it, a vibrato would be permanently on, which isn't musical. Destinations work the same: one press, red; two, blue; three, both — purple. And the trap of the evening, once more: the amount knobs are bipolar, zero at twelve o'clock. Nothing happening? Turn from twelve toward the right." **DEMO** vibrato on the wheel, ROUTE and destinations on blue; raise the wheel slowly.

SHOW: the Modulation section slide; camera on the MODULATION section (the LEDs read well on camera).

IF RUNNING LATE: never cut (it's the mechanism the rest of the evening runs on).

0:49–0:52

05.04 TRY IT

SAY: “Headphones on, on the pad from module four. In the LFO: TRIANGLE, FREQUENCY at ten o'clock. In Modulation: the ROUTE under LFO twice — blue. FREQ A and FREQ B twice each — blue. Turn the LFO's AMOUNT from twelve toward the right until you hear it, then push the mod wheel: vibrato under your control. Swap. Partner: press FREQ A and FREQ B until they go dark, press PW A twice — the pulse breathes. Then CUTOFF twice — wah. Faster, more: go too far, then bring it back.”

SHOW: the Modulation section slide stays up; you walk the tables, checking LED colors.

THEY DO: (A) LFO **triangle** on, **frequency** 10 o'clock → MOD: **route** (lfo) ×2 = blue → **freq a** ×2, **freq b** ×2 = blue → **lfo** amount from 12 o'clock to the right → mod wheel up. Swap. (B) **freq a/freq b** until dark → **pw a** ×2 → plays; then **cutoff** ×2 → **frequency** and amount higher, then back.

IF RUNNING LATE: just the wheel vibrato, 2 minutes.

0:52–0:53 05-05 KEY TERMS

SAY: “LFO, rate, vibrato, tremolo, PWM, modulation bus, mod wheel. And a promise kept: the PWM from module two — you just made it with your own hands.”

SHOW: Key Terms.

0:53–1:02 MODULE 06 · VOICES & UNISON

0:53–0:54 06-01 COVER

SAY: “So far we've built one voice. The Fourm has four — each with its own oscillators, filter and envelopes. This module is about how we spend them: spread across a chord, stacked onto one huge note, or replayed as a memorized chord from a single key. And about the loop that fattens everything.”

SHOW: cover 06. Headphones down.

0:54–0:55 06-02 POLYPHONY

SAY: “A mono synth plays one note at a time. The Fourm plays four; the fifth steals the oldest. A ten-second story: the Oberheim Four Voice, 1975, was literally four monosynths bolted into a wooden box — and in unison, one of the most overwhelming monosynths ever made. The Fourm is the same idea, in a four-kilogram box. HOLD sustains up to four notes even after your hands leave.” **DEMO** five notes, you hear the steal; then HOLD.

SHOW: the Polyphony slide; PA.

IF RUNNING LATE: no story.

0:55–0:57 06-03 UNISON

SAY: “Unison: every chosen voice — from one to four, hold UNISON and turn SELECT — on a single note. The Fourm goes monophonic and, with four voices, huge. On its own it's just louder; the magic is the detune: parameter ten, Unison Detune, a few cents between the voices and the tone turns wide, alive, pulsing. When it sounds huge, pull it back ten percent — that's usually where the good sound lives.” **DEMO** unison with no detune, then detune raised slowly until it shimmers, then too far, then back.

SHOW: the Unison slide; PA; camera on **unison + select**, then on the display at Param 10.

IF RUNNING LATE: never cut.

0:57–0:58 06-04 CHORD MEMORY

SAY: “Hold a chord, memorize it, and from then on every key plays the whole chord, transposed. One finger, full harmony — for chord stabs it's gold. It saves with the program.” **DEMO at the presenter's synth, with the real steps** (UNISON → SELECT to the middle row → Chord → UNISON → hold the chord → UNISON): memorize a minor chord and walk it chromatically with one finger. Participants just listen — the steps are in the student handbook, under Level 2.

SHOW: the Chord memory slide; PA; camera on the display.

IF RUNNING LATE: 30 s or cut entirely.

0:58-0:59 06-05 FEEDBACK

SAY: “The promise from module one: the loop. A mixer channel feeds the Fourm’s output back into the mix, with soft-clipping diodes along the way. Press FEEDBACK — it comes in at one hundred —, hold and turn SELECT for the amount. A little means warmth, a lot means snarl. Unison plus feedback is the biggest bass the Fourm can make.” **DEMO** on a held bass, feedback from clean to aggressive and back. **Optional (30 s):** “Glass Echo”, F117 — self-oscillating filter + feedback: a tuned echo appears on the release.

SHOW: the Feedback slide; PA; camera on **feedback + select**.

IF RUNNING LATE: no Glass Echo.

0:59-1:01 06-06 TRY IT

SAY: “Headphones on. Play five notes at once and count what you hear. Hold UNISON, SELECT to four voices, play a line: one huge note. Press PARAM, go to ten — Unison Detune —, press SELECT, turn to about forty, PROGRAM to exit: the tone widens. Press FEEDBACK, hold and turn SELECT down to sixty: snarl without chaos. Swap: your partner turns unison off, plays a chord, presses HOLD and lifts both hands.”

SHOW: the Feedback slide stays up; you walk the tables.

THEY DO: (A) 5 notes → hold **unison + select** = 4 → line → **param** → 10 → press **select** → ~40 → **program** → **feedback** on → hold **feedback + select** → ~60. Swap. (B) **unison** off → chord → **hold** → hands up.

IF RUNNING LATE: no detune (it stays in the student handbook), 90 s.

1:01-1:02 06-07 KEY TERMS

SAY: “Polyphony, voice, unison, detune in cents, chord memory, hold, feedback, soft clipping. The practical advice, once more: after it sounds big, pull everything back ten percent.”

SHOW: Key Terms.

1:02-1:10 MODULE 07 · EXPRESSION

1:02-1:03 07-01 COVER

SAY: “Until now we’ve been building the sound; from here on we play it. Envelopes and LFOs make every note the same; what turns that into music is what your hands add. Velocity reads how fast you strike, aftertouch reads how hard you keep pressing, glide ties the notes together. The Fourm’s Tactile keyboard feels the pressure under each individual key.”

SHOW: cover 07. Headphones down.

1:03-1:04 07-02 VELOCITY

SAY: “On real instruments, louder notes also carry more harmonics — that’s why velocity goes to the filter, not just the volume. Each envelope has a VELOCITY button: press it and how hard you play scales that envelope’s depth. Velocity on the filter envelope: soft stays dark, hard bites. Five response curves in Global, from Soft+ to Hard+, match the keyboard to your touch.” **DEMO** the same phrase pianissimo, then forte, with velocity on the filter.

SHOW: the Velocity slide; PA; camera on the **velocity** button.

1:04-1:05 07-03 POLY AFTERTOUCH

SAY: “The Fourm’s signature. After the note is down, extra pressure becomes a continuous modulator, on every key. Press into a single note of a chord and only that one blooms — like blowing harder into a flute: louder, brighter. On most keyboards aftertouch is mono, it moves all the voices at once; per-note was a rarity — the Yamaha CS-80, the Prophet T8 — and the Fourm has it natively.” **DEMO** held chord, press into each note in turn.

SHOW: the Poly aftertouch slide; PA; camera on your hand.

1:05-1:06 07-04 PRESSURE ROUTING

SAY: “Where you send the pressure: six destinations — freq A, freq B, filt, amp, LFO freq, LFO amount —, chosen with the three DEST buttons, two per button, and a single AMOUNT knob, plus or minus. Cutoff is the classic: press for brightness, let go to relax; with negative amount, it closes. Pitch is for the brave.” **DEMO** switch the destination live between filt and freq. [TEST AT HOME, before the workshop: AT → LFO amount on a single note of a chord — does only that note vibrate (per voice, as the Sequential developer says) or all of them (as the manual says)? If it's per voice, add a line here: “and a bend under one finger, via LFO amount”.]

SHOW: the Pressure routing slide; camera on the AFTERTOUCHE section.

IF RUNNING LATE: no demo.

1:06-1:07 07-05 GLIDE

SAY: “Glide, or portamento: the pitch slides from the previous note to the next instead of jumping. Press GLIDE and set the RATE — on with rate at zero it does nothing. Subtle almost always sounds more musical than spectacular: it's the difference between a keyboard melody and a phrase that sounds like a voice.” **DEMO** the same bass phrase without glide, then with. “The modes — four of them — are in the student handbook.”

SHOW: the Glide slide; PA.

IF RUNNING LATE: 30 s.

1:07-1:09 07-06 TRY IT

SAY: “Headphones on. In FILTER ENVELOPE press VELOCITY; play soft, then hard. In AFTERTOUCHE: press the DEST button under FILT/AMP until only FILT stays lit, AMOUNT at two o'clock; hold a three-note chord and press into the top note only. Now AMOUNT at ten o'clock: pressure closes the filter. Swap. Partner: GLIDE on, RATE at ten o'clock, a bass line — the notes slide. Then move the pressure to FREQ A and FREQ B, with a small amount: a bend, under one finger.”

SHOW: the Pressure routing slide stays up; you walk the tables.

THEY DO: (A) FILTER ENV **velocity** on → soft/hard → AFTERTOUCHE **dest** (FILT/AMP) until only **filt** → **amount** 2 o'clock → chord, pressure on the top note → **amount** 10 o'clock. Swap. (B) **glide** on → **rate** 10 o'clock → bass line → **dest** (FREQ A/FREQ B) → small amount → bend under a finger.

IF RUNNING LATE: no glide in the exercise (it stays a demo), 90 s.

1:09-1:10 07-07 KEY TERMS

SAY: “Velocity, poly aftertouch, pressure routing, Tactive, glide, portamento, legato. Invite your partner to feel the press inside a chord: the sensation sticks better than the definition.”

SHOW: Key Terms.

1:10-1:17 MODULE 08 · ARPEGGIATOR & SEQUENCER

1:10-1:11 08-01 COVER

SAY: “Patterns out of held notes: harmony becomes rhythm. And behind the arpeggiator, the Fourm hides a full sequencer. A mouse is not a musical instrument — that's why the arpeggiator lives on the panel.”

SHOW: cover 08. Headphones down.

1:11-1:12 08-02 HOLD A CHORD

SAY: “Press ON, hold the chord, the synth plays the pattern: up, down, up-down, random, or in the order you pressed — across one to three octaves; hold MODE or OCTAVE and turn SELECT. HOLD keeps it running hands-free. And a trick: change how many notes you're holding and the rhythm changes — it sounds like a mistake until you embrace it.” **DEMO** arp on a triad, switch directions live; then four notes, then two.

SHOW: the Hold a chord slide; PA; camera on the ARPEGGIATOR section.

1:12-1:13 08-03 CLOCK & SYNC

SAY: “One clock drives everything: tap TAP TEMPO four times, or hold it and turn SELECT for the BPM. CLK DIV picks the grid — quarters, eighths, sixteenths, triplets — and the LFO’s SYNC follows the same clock. If the arp won’t start: Clock Mode in Global is on In, waiting for external clock.” **DEMO** the same arpeggio through three divisions, without stopping the pattern.

SHOW: the Clock & sync slide; PA.

IF RUNNING LATE: no demo.

1:13–1:14 08-04 NOTE & MOD SEQ

SAY: “Beyond arpeggios: up to 64 recorded steps — notes, chords, rests, legato, even glide per step —, triggered and transposed from the keyboard; or a sequence that moves a parameter instead of playing notes: cutoff, pulse width, feedback. A sequencer in disguise, and a story for another workshop.” **The image:** “a sequencer is, at its origin, sixteen faders stepped through by a clock — the height of the faders draws the melody; that’s how ‘I Feel Love’ was made.”

SHOW: the Note & mod seq slide.

IF RUNNING LATE: cut entirely.

1:14–1:16 08-05 TRY IT

SAY: “Headphones on. Arpeggiator ON, hold C–E–G, press HOLD and lift your hands. Tap TAP TEMPO four times at your own tempo. Hold CLK DIV and turn SELECT to sixteenths, then back to eighths. Ride the CUTOFF as far as it goes. Swap. Partner: hold MODE and turn SELECT to Random; hold OCTAVE and turn SELECT to 2. Then a ‘wrong’ chord, and let it repeat: give it eight bars.”

SHOW: the Hold a chord slide stays up; you walk the tables; leave your own arp running slowly in the background.

THEY DO: (A) ARP on → C–E–G → hold → tap tempo|bpm ×4 → hold clk div + select → 1/16 → 1/8 [check at home: hold + select vs. repeated presses; it’s also Param 19] → cutoff. Swap. (B) hold mode + select → Random → hold octave + select → 2 → a “wrong” chord, 8 bars.

IF RUNNING LATE: 90 s, no mode change.

1:16–1:17 08-06 KEY TERMS

SAY: “Arpeggiator, hold, clock, BPM, division, note and mod sequencer. Leave the arps running quietly while we recap: the room stays in rhythm.”

SHOW: Key Terms.

1:17–1:30 MODULE 09 · WRAP-UP · Q&A · FREE PLAY

1:17–1:18 09-01 THE ROAD, AGAIN

SAY: “This is the road: oscillator, mixer, filter, envelopes, LFO and modulation, voices, expression, rhythm. Every synth you’ll meet from now on is the same road in different clothes. If you know the road, you know where to look.”

SHOW: The road, again slide. Headphones down.

1:18–1:20 09-02 CHALLENGE

SAY: “Last exercise, two minutes. From Basic Program, rebuild the bass from module four: A builds, B checks against the student handbook, page 04, then swap. When you’re done, write your settings into the student handbook — a sound on paper survives, one in memory rarely does.”

SHOW: The road slide stays up; you walk the tables.

THEY DO: (A) hold transpose down + program → the BASS recipe from page 04. Swap. (B) checks, then rebuilds it too.

IF RUNNING LATE: 90 s.

1:20–1:25 09-03 Q&A

SAY: “Questions. Anything — from ‘what’s that knob’ to ‘how do I make the sound from track X’.” **Your moderating rule:** with every answer, tie the term back to the demo where they heard it. When someone describes a sound, ask for concrete words: bright/dark, thin/fat, pluck/pad, static/moving.

SHOW: The road, again.

IF RUNNING LATE: 3 minutes.

1:25 – 1:26 09-04 THANK YOU

SAY: “Thank you. Zeedo, thank you for making this possible; Sequential, thank you for the instruments. On your way out you’ll get the student handbook, in English or Romanian: the same diagrams, all the theory. You’ll find us at Sintezaur — [where] — and that’s where we announce the next workshop. Until then: the synths are yours for another ten minutes.”

SHOW: the Thank you slide.

1:26 – 1:30 09-05 FREE PLAY

SAY: “Ten free minutes. One suggestion, if you want one: a single sound, sixty seconds — starts quiet, grows, hits a peak, comes down. The cutoff and the resonance are the story.” You walk the tables, going to raised hands; group photo at the end.

SHOW: Thank you stays on screen.

The Glossary annex is never presented on screen; it lives only in the student handbook.

AFTER

- **Repack:** every Fourm in its own box, with the original packaging, power supply alongside; headphones and splitters counted (20 + 10 from the kit, Zeedo’s separately); stands, power strips, extension cords; the return checklist signed.
- **Take notes within 10 minutes, while it’s fresh:** what worked, what ran long, what questions came up — for v2 of the course.

PRESENTER CHEAT SHEET

The eight exercises + the challenge, on one page

Control names are the ones on the panel (**bold**). “A → swap → B” = partner A drives, partner B reads the steps; halfway through they switch. The timebox is the one in the script; IF RUNNING LATE: 90 s and no swap.

MODULE	MINUTE	THEY DO (condensed)	WHO DRIVES
01 • SIGNAL FLOW	0:10–0:12	A: osc a to zero → silence → back; Osc B saw on, osc b up. B: repeats; both trace the path across the panel with a finger.	A, then B
02 • OSCILLATORS	0:19–0:22	A: Osc A pulse on (saw + pulse) → hold pulse pw + select toward the edge and back → Osc B tri on, octave -1, osc b up → B's frequency slightly off-centre → back. B: noise on → hold noise + select ≈ 30 → plays; then A's steps. The sound stays on the synth (raw material for the bass).	A → swap → B
03 • FILTER	0:29–0:32	A: cutoff down → up; resonance at 3 o'clock, sweep. B: main slightly down → resonance max → cutoff a bit closed → single notes; hold key track + select → Full; then resonance 9 o'clock, cutoff 12 o'clock.	A → swap → B
04 • ENVELOPES	0:38–0:43	A: BASS: AMP ENV attack 0 · decay 10 · sustain 8 · release 8 o'clock; FILTER ENV attack 0 · decay 10 · sustain min · release 8; FILTER env amt 3 o'clock · cutoff 9 o'clock; short notes; then FILTER ENV decay shorter. B: PAD: AMP ENV attack 12 · decay 0 · sustain max · release 2 o'clock; cutoff 12 · env amt 10 o'clock; Osc B saw , octave 0, frequency slightly off-centre; held chord. Good settings get written into the handbook, page 04.	A bass → swap → B pad
05 • LFO & MODULATION	0:49–0:52	A: LFO triangle on, frequency 10 o'clock → MODULATION route (LFO) ×2 = blue → freq a ×2, freq b ×2 → LFO amount from 12 o'clock to the right → mod wheel up. B: freq a / freq b until dark → pw a ×2 → plays; then cutoff ×2 → frequency and amount higher, then back.	A → swap → B
06 • VOICES & UNISON	0:59–1:01	A: 5 notes → hold unison + select = 4 → line → param → 10 → press select → ≈ 40 → program → feedback on → hold feedback + select → ≈ 60. B: unison off → chord → hold → hands up.	A → swap → B
07 • EXPRESSION	1:07–1:09	A: FILTER ENV velocity on → soft / hard → AFTERTOUCH dest (FILT / AMP) until only FILT → amount 2 o'clock → chord, pressure on the top note → amount 10 o'clock. B: glide on → rate 10 o'clock → bass line → dest (FREQ A / FREQ B) → small amount → bend under a finger.	A → swap → B
08 • ARPEGGIATOR & SEQ	1:14–1:16	A: ARP on → C–E–G → hold → tap tempo bpm ×4 → hold clk div + select → 1/16 → 1/8 → cutoff . B: hold mode + select → Random → hold octave + select → 2 → a “wrong” chord, 8 bars.	A → swap → B
09 • CHALLENGE	1:18–1:20	From Basic Program (hold transpose down + program), rebuild the bass from 04: A builds, B checks against the handbook, page 04; then the other way. Settings get written down.	A → swap → B

THE TRAPS (BACK OF THE PAGE)

- **If you hear nothing:** headphones plugged into the splitter? **main** at 12 o'clock? at least one mixer source up? **cutoff** closed? an amount left at 12 o'clock (= zero)? **key track** off while playing high? Last resort: Basic Program — hold **transpose down** + **program**.
- **Self-oscillation comes in sudden and loud:** **main** slightly down before **resonance** hits maximum. Announce it every time.
- **The amounts are bipolar** (MODULATION and **env amt**): 12 o'clock = nothing. Say “from twelve toward the right”, never just “raise the amount”.
- **sustain at maximum = the decay does nothing.** When someone “can't hear the decay”, look at the sustain.
- **program without transpose down** switches the preset and loses the sound they built. Remind them at every exercise.
- **Chord memory is demo-only**, at your synth (steps through the Unison menu) — not at the tables, not during the exercise.
- **Aftertouch → LFO amount per note: [test at home].** Until then, the safe phrasing: “press harder → brighter (FILT) / bend (FREQ), on the pressed note”.
- **CLK DIV:** hold + **select** or repeated presses [check at home]; it's also Param 19.
- **Headphones:** on while they play, one ear free while you talk; swap at every exercise, so the panel passes through both pairs of hands.